

Church History





About the Course

Using a survey of key events in the American church, articles, and extra resources on Christianity across the world in the lesson plans, this course gives students a personal and big picture look at church history during the 19th century. A second text is used to bring the people and events of the early church to life.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 10-11, Bible: Grade 12



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
10-12	Church History: Grades 10-12 1 time/week 30 min	When the Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers Turning Points in American Church History

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 10-11				
Spiritual Formation: Grades 10-11	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 10-11	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 10-12
Bible: Grade 12				
Spiritual Formation: Grade 12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 10-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Bible: Grade 12

☐ Make or purchase Bible journals for Old and New Testament studies (see some suggestions in the following course Extra Helpings: Bible: Grades 7-8, 9, 10-11, and 12).

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Church History: Grades 10-12

Check the Teacher Notes for content guidance.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Church History: Grades 10-12



When the Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers



Turning Points in American Church History



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)

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Church History: Grades 10-12

How To Approach



Recap

Take a moment to recall what you read previously in the same book or topic.



Read

Read the passage assigned or read for the number of minutes allocated. If a book is challenging for you, try stopping to narrate to yourself silently now and then to make sure you are tracking. Or you could listen to an audiobook version of the text and read along. You may also want to read aloud to yourself. If a book is an easy read, enjoy the ride! Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your Commonplace Book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. You might want to set a timer to keep yourself on track, so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

Read notes in your Study Bible or commentary. Look up places mentioned in the text in your Bible atlas. Add something to your Book of Centuries or Commonplace Book. Jot down additional reflections and thoughts in your Bible notebook or share with others.



Teacher Note

Read over the lesson plans to familiarize yourself with the content for accountability and interest. If doing the lessons together, use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to rouse students' interest before reading. You may also highlight one or two unfamiliar terms if needed. If in a classroom context, you may choose to leave larger doctrinal conversations for students to have with their parents at home.

Church History: Grades 10-12

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Term 1

WEEK 1

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: Turning Points in American Church History: How Pivotal Events Shaped a Nation and a Faith, Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Chapter 7 The Benevolent Empire, p.131-151

→IDENTIFY THREE IDEAS THAT WERE NEW TO YOU FROM THIS CHAPTER AND EXPLAIN WHY THOSE IDEAS CAPTURED YOUR ATTENTION.

WEEK 2

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Chapter 1 The Church Fathers: Who Is Included?, p.1-4
and
Chapter 2 Clement and the Corinthian Coup, p. 5-10

→ NARRATE

Explain how developing a literary relationship with the early Church Fathers can impact a person's spiritual life.

WEEK 3

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch. 3 The Didache: Out of the Mist of History, p.11-17

→ WRITE

If you were writing a catechism, what three areas of instruction would you prioritize first and why?

WEEK 4

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch. 4 Ignatius: Prophet, Pastor, and Witness, p.18-28

→ CHARACTER SKETCH

Develop a character sketch of Ignatius and share it with a family member or friend.

WEEK 5

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.5 The Martyrdom of Polycarp, p.29-37

→ DEFINE & REFLECT

Define martyrdom and reflect on the impact martyrdom has on the church.

WEEK 6

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.6 Diogenetus and the Mystery of Christian Newness, p.38-46

→ WRITE

Write down the questions the "mystery author" answered, and respond to those questions in your own words.

WEEK 7

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 7

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.7 Justin and the Philosopher's Cloak, p.47-57

→ EXPLAIN

Explain why Justin considered himself a philosopher. Why did Justin refer to Christ as a "key that unlocked all doors..."

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Term 1	
WEEK 8 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 8 Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook → READ Ch.8 Irenaeus and the Gnostic Threat, p.58-67 → LIST In your journal, identify the heresies that Irenaeus confronted, and make a list of the potential heresies the church is battling against today. Are there similarities between today's heresies and those that Irenaeus confronted?	
WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 9 Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook → READ Ch.9 Irenaeus and the Battle for the Bible, p.68-76 →EXPLAIN Explain how the canon of Scripture was established to a friend or family member.	
WEEK 10 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 10 Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook → READ Ch.10 Clement and the School of Alexandria, p.77-87 → CONTRAST Contrast gnosticism with Clement's understand of a "true" gnostic.	
WEEK 11 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 11 Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook → READ Ch.11 Origen: Zeal and Genius, p.88-101 → DESCRIBE In your journal, describe the catechetical institute of Alexandria and include the academic disciplines that were studied. Why did the institute include disciplines beyond biblical studies?	
WEEK 12 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Question will come from: When The Church Was Young	

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Term 2

WEEK 1

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 13

Materials: Turning Points in American Church History: How Pivotal Events Shaped a Nation and a Faith

→ READ

Ch. 8 Houses Divided, p.153-172

→ IDENTIFY

Identify three ideas that captured your attention and explain why.

WEEK 2

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 14

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.12 The Tragedy of Tertullian, p.102-112

→ DESCRIBE

Describe Tertullian's views on Christian persecution and martyrdom.

WEEK 3

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 15

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.13 Cyprian and the Unity of the Church, p.113-124

→ NARRATE

In your journal, identify what concerned Cyprian the most.

WEEK 4

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 16

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.14 Hippolytus and the Lex Orandi, p.125-138

→ CONTRAST

In your notebook, contrast transformation of behavior with intellectual understanding of doctrine.

WEEK 5

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 17

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.15 The Great Persecution, p.139-149

→ WRITE

In your journal, write about something that caught your attention.

WEEK 6

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 18

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.16 Nicaea, the First Ecumenical Council, p.150-161

→ EXPLAIN

Explain to a family member or a friend why the Council of Nicaea was convened.

WEEK 7

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 19

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.17 Athanasius against the World, p.162-178

→ DESCRIBE

How would you describe Athanasius's character to someone who has never heard of him?

WEEK 8

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 20

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.18 Basil the Great, p.179-191

Church History: Grades 10-12

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Term 2	
→ WRITE Write a "Rule of Life" that would challenge you to become more disciplined and intentional with your time and share it with a family member or friend.	
WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 21 📖 Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook → READ Ch.19 Two Gregorys and a Council, p.192-199 "the imperial capital" → DESCRIBE In your journal, describe the type of relationship Gregory and Basil cultivated.	
WEEK 10 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 22 📖 Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook → READ Ch.19 Two Gregorys and a Council, p.199 "Basil had helped" - p.209 → COMPARE & CONTRAST Compare and contrast the two Gregorys.	
WEEK 11 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 23 📖 Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook → READ Ch.20 Ambrose of Milan: The Jonah of the West, p.210-222 → DISCUSS Identify something that stood out to you from the reading.	
WEEK 12 30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: When The Church Was Young	

Church History: Grades 10-12

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Term 3

WEEK 1

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 25

Materials: Turning Points in American Church History: How Pivotal Events Shaped a Nation and a Faith, Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.9, p.173-192

→ WRITE

Select one of the personal letters (p.178 or p.184) and write a response letter to the individual.

WEEK 2

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 26

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.21 Augustine and Amazing Grace, p.223-232 "to contend with"

→ DESCRIBE

Describe the impact Augustine's mother had on his life.

WEEK 3

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 27

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.21 Augustine and Amazing Grace, p.233 "Ten years after" - p.242

→ WRITE

Write about something from the reading that caught your attention.

WEEK 4

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 28

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.22 The Preacher with the Golden Tongue, p.243-255

→ LIST

Make a list of the reforms John implemented to refocus the church on its mission. Are any of those reforms need today?

WEEK 5

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 29

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.23 Jerome and the Bible, p.256-265

→ WRITE

In your journal, write about something from the reading that caught your attention.

WEEK 6

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 30

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.24 Leo and Peter, p.266-274

→ DESCRIBE

Describe how Leo approached his role as pope, and explain why he was given such a unique title.

WEEK 7

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 31

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.25 Gregory the Great, p.275-279 "centuries to come"

→ WRITE

In your journal, write about something from the reading that grabbed your attention.

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Term 3

WEEK 8

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 32

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.25 Gregory the Great, p.279 "Gregory ranked effective" - p.285

→ LIST

List the qualities or skills Gregory the Great expected every pastor to develop.

WEEK 9

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 33

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.26 The Voice in the Voices, p.286-289 "Gospel of Thomas, were not."

→ DISCUSS

Read the following passage and explain what the author is communicating:

"What they passed on was not primarily a book, or a set of truths. It was a life. It was the truth...There are some things that you can only learn by absorbing them. You absorb such a thing by living with people who have it. And once absorbed, you can never fully articulate it. But you can live it, and you can pass it on to those you live with."

WEEK 10

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 34

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Ch.26 The Voice of the Voices, p.289 "The most fundamental" - 294

→ WRITE

In your journal, write about something in the reading that caused you to pause and reflect.

WEEK 11

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 35

Materials: When The Church Was Young: Voices of the Early Fathers, a Journal or Notebook

→ READ

Postscript When the Church Was Young, p.295-296

→ CATCH UP

You use this week to catch up on previous readings or assignments.

WEEK 12

30m Church History: Grades 10-12 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: When The Church Was Young

Church History: Grades 10-12

Examination

- Term 1** · When the Church Was Young: Select an Early Church Father from the reading that you enjoyed learning about and identify several things you learned from him. Explain how you are incorporating those things into your daily living.
- Term 2** · When the Church Was Young: Write about the impact persecution had on the early church. How did the Early Church Fathers respond to the persecution they faced? Include examples.
- Term 3** · When the Church Was Young: Write about three important takeaways from the reading that have impacted your daily life and explain why.